DANTE MUSSA

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Demo Reel | LinkedIn

EDUCATION

B.F.A. in 3D Graphics and Animation Expected Dec 2026
University of Colorado Denver · Denver, CO

SKILLS

3D Software: Maya (4 yrs), ZBrush (2 yrs), Substance Painter (1 yr)
Design Software: Adobe Suite (3 yrs), Photoshop
Game Engine: Unreal Engine 5

PROJECTS

WyrmRunner — Lighting Artist · Prop Texturer · Layout Artist Oct 2024 – May 2025
Senior Thesis Animated Short | Screened at SIE Film Center

- Developed character and scene lighting in Arnold, building and managing light rigs to support narrative tone and visual consistency across sequences.
- Textured hero props in Substance Painter, developing surface detail and material breakdowns for production-ready assets.
- Assembled and dressed environment layouts in Maya, positioning assets and establishing camera-relative staging for key scenes.

Rooster Mech — 3D Artist
Solo Project | Concept-to-3D Translation | Maya, Substance Painter

- Translated a 2D concept design into a fully modeled and textured 3D asset, maintaining design intent across the production pipeline.
- Textured in Maya and staged a final hero render with a custom Arnold lighting setup.

Carbine — 3D Artist
Solo Project | Original Concept | Maya, Substance Painter

- Concepted and modeled an original fictional firearm from scratch, driving the full pipeline from sketch to final asset.
- Textured in Substance Painter with aged surface detail, wear patterns, and custom decal work.

Trawler — 3D Artist
Solo Project | Hard-Surface Modeling | Maya, Arnold

- Modeled a detailed hard-surface fishing trawler in Maya with interior and exterior geometry.
- Set up and rendered a multi-angle lighting presentation in Arnold to showcase the model.

Jungle Environment — Environment Artist
Solo Project | Unreal Engine 5

- Built a fully realized real-time environment in Unreal Engine 5, integrating foliage, lighting, and atmospheric effects.
- Leveraged Lumen global illumination to achieve naturalistic lighting and mood across the scene.

Creature Bust — 3D Artist
Academic Project | ZBrush, Maya, Substance Painter

- Modified a base mesh in ZBrush to develop original creature anatomy, surface detail, and organic appendages.
- Textured in Substance Painter, achieving material definition across skin, metal, and bioluminescent organic elements.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Low Voltage Technician May–Aug 2024 & May–Aug 2025
Jersey Shore CCTV · Galloway, NJ

- Installed and maintained security wiring, conduits, IP switches, and camera systems.
- Operated bucket trucks for elevated installations and assisted with system troubleshooting.

Line Cook / Prep / FOH & BOH May 2019 – May 2023
Tony Beef · Galloway, NJ

- Supported kitchen operations across front- and back-of-house roles.
- Contributed to menu innovation with original recipe added due to customer popularity.

AWARDS

Eagle Scout, Boy Scouts of America — Recognized for leadership, initiative, and long-term project management.
Dean's Scholarship, University of Colorado Denver (2023–2024) — Awarded for academic excellence and portfolio merit.